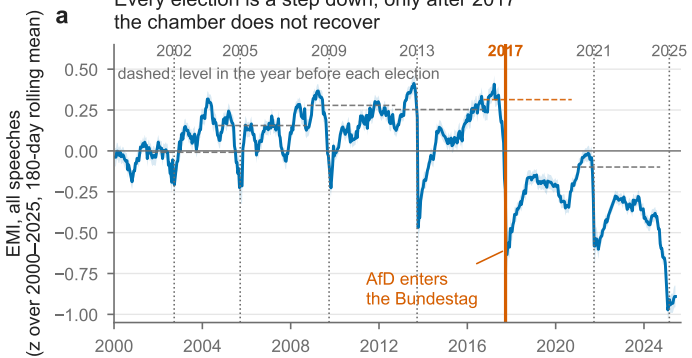
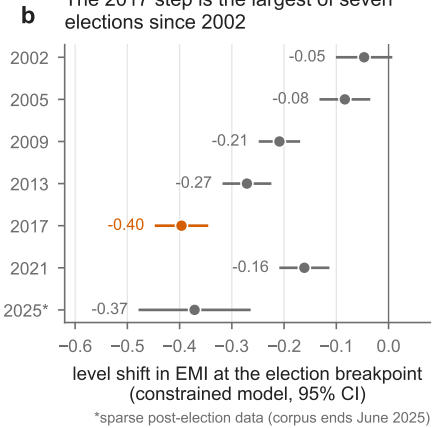
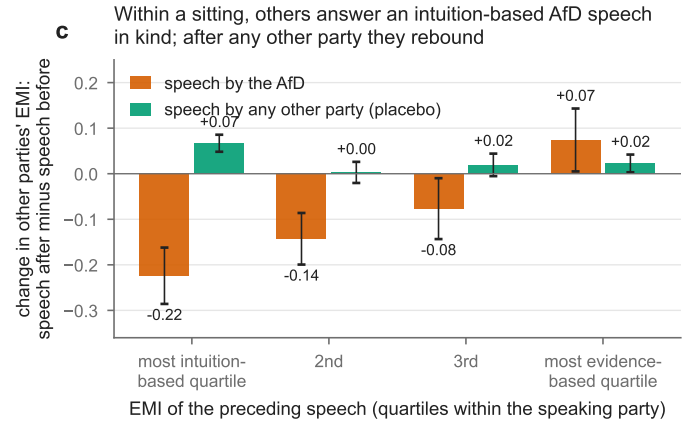
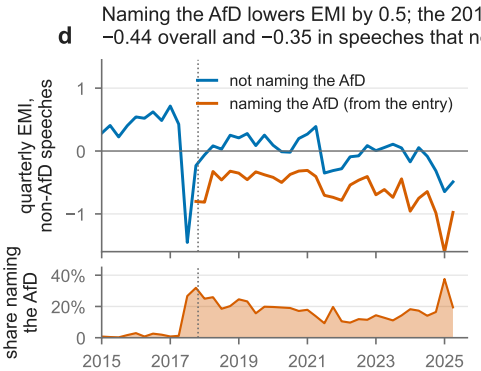

a
Every election is a step down; only after 2017 the chamber does not recover
EMI, all speeches (z over 2000–2025, 180-day rolling mean)
2002
2005
2009
2013
2017
2021
2025
dashed: level in the year before each election
AfD enters the Bundestag
0.50
0.25
0.00
−0.25
−0.50
−0.75
−1.00
2000
2004
2008
2012
2016
2020
2024


b
The 2017 step is the largest of seven elections since 2002
2002
2005
2009
2013
2017
2021
2025*
-0.05
-0.08
-0.21
-0.27
-0.40
-0.16
-0.37
−0.6
−0.5
−0.4
−0.3
−0.2
−0.1
0.0
level shift in EMI at the election breakpoint (constrained model, 95% CI)
*sparse post-election data (corpus ends June 2025)


c
Within a sitting, others answer an intuition-based AfD speech in kind; after any other party they rebound
change in other parties' EMI: speech after minus speech before
speech by the AfD
speech by any other party (placebo)
+0.07
+0.00
+0.02
+0.07
+0.02
-0.22
-0.14
-0.08
0.2
0.1
0.0
−0.1
−0.2
−0.3
most intuition-based quartile
2nd
3rd
most evidence-based quartile
EMI of the preceding speech (quartiles within the speaking party)


d
Naming the AfD lowers EMI by 0.5; the 2017 step is −0.44 overall and −0.35 in speeches that never name it
quarterly EMI, non-AfD speeches
not naming the AfD
naming the AfD (from the entry)
1
0
−1
share naming the AfD
40%
20%
0
2015
2017
2019
2021
2023
2025